

COUNTY OF VANCE

Absent: None

Pastor Valesia Perry, I Believe God Outreach Church, gave the invocation.

The next order of business was the election of the vice-chair. Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. nominated Commissioner Charisse Fain for the position of vice-chair. Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded the nomination. Vote to close the nominations and appoint Commissioner Charisse Fain as vice-chair for the coming year was unanimous.

[illegible]

Holiday	Observance Date	Day of Week
New Year's Day	January 1, 2026	Thursday
Martin Luther King, Jr. Birthday	January 19, 2026	Monday
Good Friday	April 3, 2026	Friday
Memorial Day	May 25, 2026	Monday
Juneteenth	June 19, 2026	Friday

Independence Day	July 3, 2026	Friday
Labor Day	September 7, 2026	Monday
Veterans Day	November 11, 2026	Wednesday
Thanksgiving	November 26 & 27, 2026	Thursday, Friday
Christmas	December 24, 25 & 28, 2026	Thursday, Friday, Monday

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2026 Meeting Schedule. Motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to adopt the following Board of Commissioners’ meeting and work session schedule for 2026.

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**Board of Commissioners
2026 Meeting Schedule
Commissioners’ Meeting Room
122 Young Street, Henderson, NC**

Regular Meetings – 6:00 p.m.	Work Sessions – 4:00 p.m.
Monday, January 5	Monday, January 19
Monday, February 2	Monday, February 16
Monday, March 2	Monday, March 16
Monday, April 6	Monday, April 20
Monday, May 4	Budget Work Sessions – dates tbd
Monday, June 1	---
Monday, July 6	---
Monday, August 3	Monday, August 17
Monday, September 14	Monday, September 21
Monday, October 5	Monday, October 19
Monday, November 2	Monday, November 16
Monday, December 7	---

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Public Officials and Employee Bonds. Motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the following values of bonds for certain public officials and employees.

Finance Director	\$1,000,000
Finance Director (TDA)	\$ 60,000
County Manager	\$ 50,000
Tax Administrator	\$ 100,000
Register of Deeds	\$ 25,000
Sheriff	\$ 25,000

Public comments were heard next. Steve Lyles signed up to speak about county administration. Mary Susan Williams signed up to speak about taxes.

Sheriff Curtis Brame appeared before the board to present his revisions to the county vehicle and maintenance policy. Sheriff Brame expressed his concerns about the county vehicle and maintenance policy; as well as the new sheriff vehicles that are parked and not accessible to the sheriff’s department to the Board of Commissioners. Following a discussion with the board of commissioners, the county manager, and the county attorney, Commissioner Dan Brummitt makes a motion to allow the sheriff’s department to have the new sheriff vehicles and the jurisdiction to remain functioning under the rules of the Sheriff. There was not a second to the motion. Sheriff Brame remains in disagreement with the policy and is unwilling to abide. Therefore, causing the vehicles to remain parked and not accessible to the sheriff’s department.

Mr. Frankie Nobles, Vance County Employee Engagement Team Chair, was next on the agenda to recognize the new employee of the month. He noted that at the November 20th engagement team committee meeting, committee members selected this month’s employee of the month due to the years of service to Vance County. The employee of the month is Kimberly Choplin who works for DSS as an Income Maintenance Worker 2. Ms. Choplin will receive a monetary gift and a designated parking space for the month. She was presented with a plaque of appreciation, and the board congratulated him on receiving this recognition.

Logan Parson, LKC Engineering presented to the board for consideration of approval the Change Order #2, Phase 1B for the Vance County Water District. It was noted that the total cost of Change Order #2 would be \$51,987.71 instead of \$64,839.71 which was the amount that was previously quoted. This is a savings of \$12,852.00. Recommendation: To approve pending final concurrences from the USDA & NCDEQ funding agencies. (Note: This recommendation will be brought back before the board for consideration during the Water District Board portion of the meeting.)

Sherry Moss, Director of Planning and Development then presented to the board the rezoning request for ZMA25-003 and ZMA25-004. Following her presentation, it was noticed that the public hearing portion of the meeting was not placed on the agenda. Therefore, this portion of

the meeting had to be moved to a later date. So, a special-called meeting for the public hearing was scheduled for Tuesday, December 16, 2025, at 4:00 p.m.

Water District Board

Chair Carolyn Faines called the Water District Board to order.

From the presentation presented earlier in the meeting by Logan Parsons, LKC Engineering, a recommendation was made that the board consider approving the Change Order #2, Phase 1B as presented, pending final concurrences from the USDA and NCDEQ funding agencies.

Motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to approve the change order #2, Phase 1B as presented, pending final concurrences from the USDA and NCDEQ funding agencies

2026 Water District Board Meeting Schedule. Motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote was unanimous, to adopt the following Water District Board meeting schedule for 2026.

**Water District Board 2026 Meeting Schedule
Commissioners’ Meeting Room 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC**

Regular Meetings – 6:00 p.m.
Monday, January 5
Monday, February 2
Monday, March 2
Monday, April 6
Monday, May 4
Monday, June 1
Monday, July 6
Monday, August 3
Monday, September 14
Monday, October 5
Monday, November 2
Monday, December 7

The October 2025 monthly operations report was presented to the board for information.

Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

Finance Director’s Report

The Fiscal Operations Policy was removed from the agenda to incorporate updates requested by the County Attorney prior to presentation to the Board. The revised policy will be brought forward for the Board’s consideration and possible approval during the special-called meeting scheduled for Tuesday, December 16, 2025, at 4:00 p.m.

Assistant County Manager's Report

EMS Incentive Pay. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones presented to the board for consideration of the EMS Incentive Pay program. The incentive program will not only strengthen our current workforce but also help attract new employees. Right now, we are the lowest-paid EMS agency among the surrounding counties, despite being the busiest. This program gives our staff hope that competitive pay is attainable and shows potential applicants that Vance County EMS is committed to investing in its people and employing the best. It will motivate our employees to better themselves, which in turn will enhance the service we provide for the community. The program establishes clear goals, boosts morale, and encourages both professional and personal growth. Ultimately, it supports a holistic approach to delivering high-quality service to the residents of Vance County. This plan will utilize lapse salaries that total \$46,447.19. Recommendation: Approve the incentive plan as well as adjust the budget for the plan going forward.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to approve the incentive plan as well as adjust the budget for the plan going forward.

(A copy of the incentive pay program will be kept on file in the County Manager's office.)

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Vance County EMS Educational Incentive Pay Program

I. PURPOSE

The Vance County EMS Educational Incentive Pay Program encourages and rewards employees who pursue higher education or professional development. It helps retain motivated, skilled personnel and attract qualified applicants. By offering financial incentives, Vance County EMS aims to: Support ongoing education and professional growth, decrease employee turnover, and stay competitive with surrounding agencies for top talent.

II. SCOPE

Applies to full-time employees within Vance County EMS. Incentive amounts are based on the employee's base salary: **5%** for major educational achievements (max of 2 items) **2%** for certifications, licenses, or specialized training (max of 5 items), **Maximum total incentive: 20%** If a degree, certification, or license expires, the incentive increase will be revoked until recertified. Part-time employees are eligible for up to 10% total under the same conditions. If the certification is a required part of the job description, no incentive will be applied.

III. GUIDELINES

To qualify for the incentive, employees must:

- Provide proof of completion: Submit an official transcript or certification from an accredited institution.

Telework Policy. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that the Countywide Telework Policy, which establishes a structured and consistent framework for the use of telework across Vance County Government, maintains the County's commitment to operational efficiency, service

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous; to approve the Telework policy as written and approve the Department of Social Services (DSS) to serve as the initial pilot department and authorize the County Manager to phase in additional departments as feasible and appropriate.

(A copy of the telework policy will be kept on file in the County Manager's office.

Revised Emergency Operations Plan (EOP). Ms. Perry reported that the Board of Commissioners tabled the approval of the revised EOP due to questions and concerns brought up during the November regular meeting. The Board of Commissioners had the opportunity to email or meet in person by November 14, 2025, to discuss changes before the December regular meeting. There were no requests for in-person meetings or email requests for changes. I am requesting approval as written, with the understanding that a more detailed review, such as minor spelling corrections or incorporation of Commissioner Brummitt's recommended additions—can occur at a later date should the Board wish to do so. Recommendation: Approve the revised EOP as written.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. to approve the revised EOP as written.

This motion was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain and vote was ayes – six (6); noes – one (1), with the dissenting vote being cast by Commissioner Dan Brummitt.

- Enhance internal controls and reduce the risk of delay in critical financial processes.

Although not required by statute, having a formally appointed Deputy Finance Officer is considered a best practice across North Carolina counties and will support effective financial stewardship and daily operational efficiency. This request is also highly recommended by the LG since we are still on the Unit Assistance List. Recommendation: Appoint Alicia Campbell as Deputy Finance Officer.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous; to appoint Alicia Campbell as Deputy Finance Officer.

Consent Agenda

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Yolanda Feimster, vote was unanimous; to approve the following consent agenda items as presented: Budget Amendment #21, Budget Amendment #22, and Budget Amendment #23, October 2025 Tax Refunds and Releases, departmental monthly reports, and the minutes of the November 3, 2025, regular board meeting.

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**Budget Amendment #21
FY 2025-2026
Fines & Forfeitures**

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fines & Forfeitures Revenue	76-360-435601	500,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$500,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Fines & Forfeitures Expense	76-500-500011	500,000
Total		\$500,000

Purpose: Increase Budget for Fines and Forfeitures to allow for receipting of funds from Clerk of Superior Court and the disbursement to Vance County Schools.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
December 1, 2025

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**Budget Amendment #22
FY 2025-2026
Animal Control**

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Petrie Foundation	10-332-433212	50,000

Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$50,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Petrie Foundation	10-599-500212	50,000
Total		\$50,000

Purpose: Approval to accept spay and neutering grant from Petrie Foundation. No match is required.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
December 1, 2025

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Budget Amendment #23
FY 2025-2026
Finance

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	21,933.16
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$21,933.16

Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Escheat	10-555-500462	21,933.16
Total		\$21,933.16

Purpose: Approval to use Fund Balance to escheat checks from prior financial system in FY 2018-2020. When prior system closed, checks amounts were rolled into fund balance and are now needed to process escheat.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
December 1, 2025

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TAX OFFICE REFUNDS AND RELEASE REPORT FOR OCTOBER 2025

TAXPAYER NAME	TAX YR	REAL	PERSONAL	SOLID WASTE FEE	REASON
ROSES EMILY	2019	\$0.00	\$56.06	\$112.00	PERS PROP BILLED
ROSES EMILY	2020	\$0.00	\$58.58	\$117.00	PERS PROP BILLED
LEACH RODNEY	2023	\$0.00	\$16.16	\$120.00	PERS PROP BILLED
RESENDIZ JOSE	2023	\$0.00	\$83.41	\$120.00	PERS PROP BILLED
LEACH RODNEY	2024	\$0.00	\$12.91	\$125.00	PERS PROP BILLED
MOODY STEPHEN D	2024	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$125.00	REMOVE SOLID WAS
RESENDIZ JOSE	2024	\$0.00	\$69.32	\$125.00	PERS PROP BILLED
BEAR ROCK CONCRETE & PRECAST	2025	\$0.00	\$153.81	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED
BEAR ROCK CONCRETE & PRECAST	2025	\$0.00	\$193.18	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED
CABANA ROBERT JOSEPH	2025	\$0.00	\$54.49	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED
CASTRO FRANCISCO	2025	\$1,935.72	\$0.00	\$146.00	CORRECT OWNERSHI

